no temples for the gods. T h e vitality and affirmation of life pervading them are extraordinary. T h e early Vedic Aryans were so full of the zest for life that they paid little attention to the soul. In a vague way they believed in some kind of existence after death.

Gradually the conception of God grows: there are the Olympian type of gods, a n d then monotheism, and later, rather mixed with it, the conception of monism. Thought carries them to strange realms, a n d brooding on nature's mystery comes, and the spirit of inquiry. These developments take place in the course of hundreds of years, a n d by the time we reach the end of the Veda, the *Vedanta (anta,* meaning end), we have the philosophy of the Upanishads.

T h e Rig Veda, the first of the Vedas, is probably the earliest book that humanity possesses. In it we can find the first outpourings of the h u m a n mind, the glow of poetry, the rapture at nature's loveliness and mystery. And in these early hymns there are, as Dr. Macnicol says, the beginnings of 'the brave adventures m a d e so long ago a n d recorded here, of those who seek to discover the significance of our world and of man's life